

of the nations whom the great and noble Asenapper brought over and set in the cities of Samaria' (Ezra iv. 10). How can these differences be reconciled, and how could still larger numbers have been settled in the few towns of Samaria, always remembering that the indigenous population was still there, and how could such a change have taken place in less than 150 years? It is the second point which has first to be established before we consider the alleged plantation of the new peoples.

In the year B.C.E. 726, Hezekiah, then king of Judah, invited the Northern Tribes, now that their political existence had almost come to an end and shortly before their chief priests were carried away into exile, to join with him in celebrating the Pass-over in Jerusalem.¹ By this means he tried to reunite all the tribes, not so much under his political sway as under the religious rule of the central Temple of Jerusalem. To this invitation some of the tribes responded favourably, among them being Manasseh, Zebulun, and Asher (v. 11), as well as some of Ephraim and Issachar (v. 18). Nearly 100 years later, in the year 630, during his great War of Reformation, Josiah still met the tribes of Manasseh and Ephraim, Simeon and Naphtali, in Northern Israel.² Neither Hezekiah nor Josiah mention any heathen nations; they do not even refer to their existence, still less to their having supplanted the original Israelitish inhabitants; nor do they say that the land had become a desert. Now these nations which are mentioned under different names at different times must therefore represent, not, as has hitherto been considered, new settlements of colonists, but simply garrisons drawn from these various nations. It was a known practice of the ancient kings to settle garrisons in conquered territories, a policy followed by Egypt and Assyria, later by the Persian kings, then by Alexander, and finally by the Romans. Everywhere soldiers were drawn from distant countries and settled in various fortified camps, which were often changed when the attitude of the nations from which they had been drawn and their loyalty to their overlord had undergone serious political changes. If a province rebelled the king could not rely upon the loyalty of his troops in distant parts which were drawn from the rebellious provinces; hence the change of the garrisons and the names of the nations in the second list as far as can be ascertained. The Persian kings themselves placed Jewish and Samaritan garrisons in

¹ 2 Chron. xxx. 1 ff.

² 2 Chron. xxxiv. 6, 7.